

Deal 1 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners

Q1096♣

A642♦

Q52♠

J5♥

AJ2♣

KQJ3♦

K764♠

K7♥

Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners			
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Deal 3 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners

AJ65♣

8743♦

Q107♠

K3♥

K9♣

AK62♦

AJ98♠

8852♥

Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners			
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 10 8 3

♥ Q 9 6 4

♦ 10 8

♣ K 7 3

♠ K 7 6 4

♥ K 7

♦ K Q J 3

♣ A J 2



♠ J 9

♥ A 10 8 3 2

♦ 9 7 5

♣ 8 5 4

♠ Q 5 2

♥ J 5

♦ A 6 4 2

♣ Q 10 9 6

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

need an extra dummy entry to enjoy that last winner.

So win the ♥K and play the ♦ K Q. If both defenders follow suit you can afford to overtake your ♦J with dummy's ♦ A. Now play the ♣ 10 and let it ride. If it holds the trick play another ♣ to your ♣J and then play the ♣A, dropping West's ♣K.

Enter dummy by playing your ♦ 3 to the ♦ 6 and take your established ♣ for the ninth trick.

Suppose a defender showed out on the second ♦.

With only one outside entry to dummy your choices are limited.

You might play West for ♣ K x and lead a small to your ♣J, then play ♣A.

Or you might try leading the ♣Q hoping that West will see this as a time to "cover an honor with an honor".

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♥3, you play dummy's ♥J and West plays the ♥Q.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=4 ♣=1 Total = 6

Unless you want to go down really, really early you had better take your ♥K right now. And unless you want to go down almost as early you'd better stay completely away from the ♠ suit. So that only leaves you the ♣ suit to get 3 more winners in. West will have to have ♣K so you can finesse it. You are also going to have to be smart with entries. Got it?

If West has just ♣ K x then one finesse, followed by the ♣A to drop the ♣K and a small ♣ back to dummy will give you the 4 ♣ winners you must have. But if West has ♣ K x x and refuses to cover then you will be able to establish the ♣s but will

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 10 7
 ♥ K 3
 ♦ 8 7 4 3
 ♣ A J 6 5

♠ K 5 3 2
 ♥ A Q J 10
 ♦ J 10
 ♣ 7 3 2



♠ A J 9 8
 ♥ 8 5 2
 ♦ A K 6 2
 ♣ K 9

♠ 6 4
 ♥ 9 7 6 4
 ♦ Q 9 5
 ♣ Q 10 8 4

West	North	East	South
		1NT	Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

better cash the ♣A next, then the ♠Q, letting it ride if not covered. Finally, one last ♠ finesse gives you 4 ♠ winners.

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♣4, you play dummy's ♣5 and North plays the ♣7.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=3 Total = 6

You'd really like to find 3 winners without broaching that ♥ suit, so you decide to pin your hopes on the ♠ finesse. But you have a problem. When you win the first trick with the ♣9 your only safe entry to dummy is by leading your ♣K to the ♣A. And this uses up one of your ♣ winners! Do you see a way to avoid the problem?

Don't win the first trick with the ♣9, win with the ♣K. Then at trick two enter dummy by playing your ♣9 and finessing the ♣J! You are pretty sure South has led from the ♣Q so you expect this to work.

Then play the ♠10, underplaying your ♠8. You had

This is another twist on the them of winning with a higher card than necessary.

Here it doesn't actually create an extra entry, it just preserves the one entry you have but saves you an actual trick.

Here is an interesting point. Suppose that South's opening lead had been a ♥ and North had taken the first four ♥ tricks then played a ♦. You would have played the hand the same way! Take the ♣K, then finesse the ♣J.